

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific**

~~tracked), not a flat "18th death" — that softer framing is carried everywhere below.~~
The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts
~~A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED~~
~~FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED~~
~~because even this is a weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority — not because of an unresolved flag this time, see My Decision below.~~
FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76, still LEFT AS DRAFT (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp).

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS									
WINDOW	JUN		8/16	8/22	8/22	QUAL	IMP	SIGNAL	MY CALL
Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 22, 2026 — full weekly refresh, score set 2026-08-22_draft2 (P held flat at 14/22/38/54/76 after independent re-verification — DRAFT, awaiting my stamp; full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp) · Not Financial Advice									
1 month	50	...	20	14	14	0.60	8	-3.46	Strong Bear — the worst
3 months	55	...	28	22	22	0.65	8	-2.91	1-month signal in the whole matrix, held flat this cycle after re-verification
6 months	62	...	41	38	38	0.70	8	-1.34	Bear
1 year	75	...	56	54	54	0.65	8	+0.42	Mild Bear
3 years	85	...	77	76	76	0.55	8	+2.29	Neutral — dip-buy thesis thinning further
									Bull

Draft P (Aug 22 draft2, pending stamp): 14 / 22 / 38 / 54 / 76 (unchanged from draft) · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 50/55/62/75/85 (Jun 19) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8–Aug 7 path) → Aug 8 20/28/41/56/77 (cut at 1mo/3mo — full-week re-verification surfaces five missed tanker attacks plus a new Saudi front — committed and stamped by Alex) → Aug 9-16 20/28/41/56/77 (held flat across six touches — **Aug 16 remains the last COMMITTED baseline**) → Aug 17/18/20/21 drafts (16-20 / 24-28 range, never committed, delivered, or archived — superseded) → Aug 22 draft 14/22/38/54/76 (four parallel primary-source research passes independently re-verify the gap since Aug 16; the vessel-seizure fact and a corrected UAE-attack-history read support a further front-end cut, but an adversarial re-check found the draft's "first fatality" framing false — see My Decision) → **Aug 22 draft2 14/22/38/54/76 (HELD FLAT)** — a separate full weekly refresh, same day, ran a second dedicated adversarial pass specifically re-checking the casualty-toll figure (confirmed real but softer than a clean number — see below — now framed as a 15-19 range) and the Aug 19-22 window (no new kinetic incident found; an initially-flagged UAE missile claim reconciled as the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one) — **LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED — full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority.**

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Held flat this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76, versus the Aug 16 committed baseline of 20/28/41/56/77 (the largest single-window move remains –6, at 1mo, set by the Aug 22 draft earlier the same day and unchanged since) — **left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. This section is the FULL WEEKLY refresh: independent re-research plus a *second*, dedicated adversarial-verification pass targeting specifically (a) whether the casualty-toll claim that drove the morning draft holds up, and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. **The Iranian vessel seizure still holds up:** the tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17 and remained detained as of Aug 19 (Fars News, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News) —

confirmed the first such seizure since June 22, a real shift from harassment/attacks to active enforcement under Iran's new post-MoU toll regime. **The fatality claim's underlying toll is real but softer than a clean number:** the Liberia-flagged bulker Minoan Dignity was struck by an unknown projectile in the engine room Aug 17-18, killing the chief engineer (UKMTO, corroborated by Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 — 7+ independent outlets) — that incident is real and it is not the campaign's first fatality. This cycle re-verified the cumulative toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox shows **18** total (17 seafarers + 1 port worker); a mid-July gCaptain snapshot said "at least 15"; IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows **19** seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but that page appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (potentially including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6 per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz campaign cleanly. Net: the honest figure is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — a toll this report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on regardless of the exact count. **No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking. **The UAE claim, initially re-flagged as a possible miss, reconciles to the same known episode:** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing a UAE missile attack and resulting trade-embargo suspension is the SAME Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera sourcing), not a second incident — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance, not new information. It remains single-source on attribution (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating this incident; that "novel escalation vector" framing remains retired. Offsetting/continuation: CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected as of Aug 22 vs. ~67 shortly before — an existing pattern, not a fresh shock); the Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remains unsigned as of Aug 22; Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain (~6%) and the highest since late July, rising toward but not through the \$100 flip line; Bessent's promised sanctions remain mostly rhetoric. None of this clears the sufficiency bar for a further move in either direction — it's confirmation of the already-priced casualty finding (with a softened, ranged framing), reconciliation of an initially-flagged "miss" into an already-known event, and a continuing-deadlock diplomatic picture consistent with, not worse than, the existing baseline. P HELD FLAT.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. The Amara seizure rests on 2+ independent maritime-security/wire outlets — above the sufficiency bar. The Minoan Dignity strike itself is equally well-sourced; this cycle's dedicated re-verification confirms the cumulative death toll is real, corroborated across Wikipedia's tracker, gCaptain, and IMO's own incident page, though the trackers disagree on the precise count (15-19 depending on scope) — reported as a range, not a point figure, per the sufficiency rule for anything short of a clean, single, corroborated number. That range-not-point finding is itself a Quality-process result: the earlier same-day draft's "roughly the 18th" framing was more precise than the underlying sources actually support, and this cycle's second adversarial pass corrected that precision. The UAE missile claim remains single-source and disputed and is reported as such, not treated as settled fact. Quality (the 0-1 input) itself is unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp), up from \$71,882.92 on Aug 20 — a further +7.4% move over a window when this pillar's own evidence, if anything, got modestly worse (a campaign death toll re-confirmed, a vessel seizure, Brent's second straight weekly gain). That tape move is already reflected in the quant pillar, not an Iran-specific reaction, and per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match it — see The Claim below for the honesty check on that divergence.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated August 22, 2026

The crowd: keeps treating each "very close" or "agreement reached" announcement as if it were the resolution itself, rather than checking whether the underlying facts (an unsigned deal, continued attacks, hardening terms) actually moved — and, this cycle, treating a single-source, disputed missile claim as more novel than it actually was.

Me: holding flat at 14/22/38/54/76 versus the Aug 16 committed baseline of 20/28/41/56/77 — this is a same-day full weekly refresh on top of this morning's Aug 22 draft, and I'm leaving it as a draft rather than committing it. The UAE missile claim isn't the story — independent re-verification found it's still single-source and, contrary to the framing carried since Aug 20, not actually the first time the UAE has been hit (April and May incidents predate it, both Iran-attributed); a version of this claim dated Aug 19 in some outlets is the same episode, not a second one, and I ran that reconciliation down explicitly this cycle rather than assume it. What actually moves the needle is Iran's first vessel seizure since June 22 (the tanker Amara) — a real shift from harassment to active detention. What I corrected earlier today: I had drafted the Minoan Dignity's fatal strike as "the first confirmed fatality" in the tanker campaign. That was wrong. This cycle I ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass specifically re-checking that toll, and it holds up as real but softer than a clean number — cross-checking Wikipedia, gCaptain, and IMO's own tracker puts it at a 15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific counts), not a flat "18th death." That range is now the honest framing everywhere in this report. I'm not moving P further on it this cycle — the toll is already reflected in the front-end cut I made this morning, and re-verifying it more precisely doesn't, by itself, clear the bar for another move.

My edge: the crowd is vulnerable to over-reacting to a dramatic-sounding single-source claim (a "missile attack on a new state") while under-weighting quieter, better-corroborated escalation (a vessel seizure) buried in maritime-security trade press rather than headline wires — I corrected the UAE record and moved on the seizure. But my own earlier draft today made the same mistake in reverse on the fatality: I treated an incident's dramatic framing ("first fatality") as verified without checking it, and it took a dedicated adversarial pass to catch that it wasn't. This cycle's second adversarial pass went one step further and found my own corrected "roughly the 18th" framing was itself more precise than the underlying sources support — the honest number is a range. Naming that precisely, not rounding it to a clean headline figure either direction, is the discipline this system is supposed to enforce on me.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC rose from \$71,882.92 (Aug 20 close) to \$77,169.40 (Aug 22, Bitstamp) — a further +7.4% move — over a window when this pillar's own evidence, if anything, got modestly worse (a campaign fatality, a vessel seizure). Per this system's own discipline, this pillar's score is **not** adjusted to chase or match BTC's move — it scores evidence, not price action — but the divergence itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of August 22, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a same-day FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) on top of this morning's Aug 22 draft; its own re-verification findings appear first, then the Aug 20-22 draft facts, then earlier facts carried forward, re-verified where noted (still load-bearing).

- ★ ★ **NEW (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified: real, but a range, not a point figure.** This cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox shows 18 total (17 seafarers + 1 port worker); a mid-July gCaptain snapshot said "at least 15"; IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6, per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz campaign cleanly. Honest range: **15-19 cumulative deaths, 17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers** — softened from this morning's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources actually support.
- **NEW (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in this window found nothing beyond what's already in the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- **NEW (draft2) — the UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing a UAE missile attack and resulting indefinite trade/financial-ties suspension was initially flagged by this cycle's

adversarial pass as a possible miss; on reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" — genuinely disputed, both sides single-source on their own claims.

- **NEW (draft2) — CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally continues climbing incrementally** (68 vessels redirected as of Aug 22 per one tracker, vs. ~67 shortly before) — continuation of an existing pattern, not a fresh shock.
- **NEW (draft2) — the Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remains unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a comprehensive deal, already reflected in the baseline — no new signature reported since.
- **NEW (draft2) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — rising toward but not through the \$100 flip line already established in this pillar's trigger table (TradingEconomics, Bloomberg).
- **NEW (draft2) — Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagree on the exact daily transit count** (estimates range from ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline depending on source), but all agree traffic remains near-total disruption — status quo, not a new development.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ **★ NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulker Minoan Dignity (Modion Maritime, Greece) was struck by an unknown projectile in the engine room while exiting the Strait's southern corridor, Aug 17-18; the chief engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility yet. **Re-verified this cycle (draft2): the cumulative toll is a 15-19 range, not a clean figure** — see the NEW (draft2) item above. This report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagged honestly as a research gap, not new information, and a reason this cycle is left as a draft rather than auto-stamped.
- ★ **★ NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iran's new post-MoU transit/toll regime. Still detained as of Aug 19 (Windward, Hellenic Shipping News) — a shift from attacks-only to active enforcement and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as this report's Aug 20 draft framed it — UAE was hit by missile/drone barrages in April and at its Fujairah port May 4, both predating this incident. That "novel escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to "early next week" (~Aug 24) as of Aug 21-22. One concrete action found: an Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent designation of 10 Hezbollah-linked individuals/networks — real, but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which has not yet been unveiled.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war" Aug 22.

- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile landed in its territorial waters. Iran's foreign ministry disputes involvement outright — a live, unresolved, single-source-attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of how the missile-attack attribution dispute resolves. *Re-checked this cycle (draft2): separate Aug 19-dated reporting (NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.*
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18**, causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the significance, claiming "the United States began violating the memorandum shortly after its June 18 signing" — the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle them very easily" — the first time this conflict's rhetoric has named Oman, previously a mediator, as a potential target. This followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM's cumulative tally is now 64 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded (up from 62/3 previously cited). *Note: the pre-war baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line but the clearest upward move in several cycles (continued rising toward ~\$92 by Aug 19, per above).
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries), and a further ADNOC vessel was hit in the hull Aug 15 (CBS News live desk citing UKMTO, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) reported Iran's stipulations explicitly include a US withdrawal of its naval blockade, compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — a lower-boil, still-disrupted status quo.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg, Fortune) — the same rephrased-condition picture now folded into today's compensation-dispute read.
- **★ Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government accounts, corroborated by US News/AP wire and Al Jazeera-linked reporting — a genuinely lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible directional read; flagged, not scored.
- **★ Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9**, a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent outlets) report the strike; Saudi Arabia's energy ministry said there were no injuries and firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, Rappler, Aug 8-9): Araqchi said Iran and Oman are "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- **★ The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting Hormuz, while Oman publicly condemned "repeated attacks on vessels" transiting the waterway without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying Qatari LNG (Jul 31); a separate explosion hit near a vessel on the Omani side (Aug 2); bulk carrier Minoan Pioneer was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at a trickle."
- **★ ★ NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7**, wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns). CNN's own headline: "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).

- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that nonetheless raises the tail-risk ceiling given Pakistan's nuclear status if Saudi Arabia is drawn further into the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping**, banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA state media, corroborated by Fortune, NPR, Al Jazeera, Bloomberg) — Washington explicitly rejected these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous," and Iran denied direct talks had even resumed — treat the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed points as under review and finalization, "provided certain third parties do not obstruct the process."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle has been reached on almost all the raised issues, including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants zero fees. Eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting the plan; Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the pause. Separately, a Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance for Gulf/Red Sea shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org: a separate tanker was hit by an unknown projectile off Oman's Musandam Peninsula, its engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first coordination meeting in Riyadh — a genuine structural de-escalation-adjacent development, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the cancellation came after "the perimeters of a deal" were agreed over the Aug 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.

- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump responded by calling Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iranstore.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was said to be forming.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an arrangement: inbound traffic via a northern lane in Iranian waters, outbound via a southern lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — ballistic missiles/drones, described as a "surprise attack," all intercepted by US/Jordanian defenses, **zero US casualties**. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them." CNN's Jul 30 live coverage explicitly frames this as "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, Nineveh, Basra, Kirkuk, Karbala, and Diyala — **20 killed, 32 wounded** (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). Fire contained, no injuries. No group has claimed responsibility; Houthis explicitly deny involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the renewed strikes and widening war (Fortune). A previously-circulated "\$87.53" figure could not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting Trump's public claims of productive talks. A regional 10-day ceasefire proposal (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one failed 49-47.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced dispute (NYT officials, Rep. Massie on record) over whether the reversion dodges the 90-day War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.

- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, Jul 30: the Strait "will remain closed."
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel–Iran exchange since June 7–8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crashed crypto on Iran-specific grounds — BTC closed at **\$64,706** on Jul 30, even as the conflict spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~**\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~**+25–29% above the low within a week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

Araghchi's "very close" framing has now been overtaken by the 60-day MoU window formally lapsing (Aug 18) with both sides blaming each other for the breach, and further overtaken by the campaign's first confirmed fatality and first vessel seizure since June — the deal remains unsigned, and the conflict grinds on, not resolved. BTC closed at **\$77,169.40** on Aug 22, up +7.4% from Aug 20's \$71,882.92 — the tape's own move here runs the *opposite* direction of this pillar's own worst 1-month signal in the matrix, over a window when the evidence, if anything, got modestly worse. That's logged as an honesty check for the reader (see The Claim), not treated as pillar-scoring evidence — this report scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. If a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept gets signed and holds — and holds through a full week without a new tanker attack, fatality, or seizure, not just a quiet news day — the upside case shifts from "the market shrugs off the next attack" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium currently priced into Iran's near-term signal unwinds for real" — a bigger, more durable prize than another muted-reaction data point. Still thin and no closer to signed — a formally lapsed deadline plus a campaign now producing its first death and first seizure move the picture the wrong way, even as sanctions remain mostly rhetoric and no new US strikes have landed; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **This cycle's own correction might still be too small — in the other direction now.** If the tanker campaign has actually killed somewhere in the 15–19 range of seafarers/port workers since February and this report never scored on most of those deaths, the honest response might not be "hold the front-end cut at 6 points and now hold flat again," it might be "this pillar's P has been too generous for weeks and needs a much larger true-up." Two consecutive cycles re-verifying the same toll without moving P further than the first cut is itself worth Alex weighing directly.
- **Correcting the UAE "novel escalation" framing down doesn't mean the underlying claim is nothing.** Even though UAE was hit before (April, May), the trade suspension it announced Aug 19 is a real, dated, structural fact

independent of how the missile-attribution dispute resolves — this report may be under-weighting it now by leaning too hard the other way on correction.

- **The correction itself might still be too small.** Five tanker attacks in a week plus a strike on a fourth country (Saudi Arabia) is a genuinely worse pattern than a 4-point 1mo cut implies — a stricter read of "the war is actively widening, not stabilizing" could justify a larger move than this report is taking.
- **Iran just publicly proposed terms Washington immediately rejected — that's a real gap opening, not closing.** A ban on US and Israeli vessels plus 20% cargo fines is not a starting point for compromise with a US administration insisting on zero tolls and total freedom of navigation; if this is Iran's actual negotiating position, "close to a deal" may be badly overstated.
- **The pattern all week has been progress-then-complication, and this cycle's own correction proves it.** Aug 1's quiet night gave way to Aug 2's tanker attacks; Aug 4's canceled strike came with a bulker attack the same day; Aug 6's route-map understanding came with a fee dispute the same day; Aug 7-8's "finalized agreement" claim came with explicit US rejection and, this full-weekly review reveals, a fourth country coming under attack the same week. Each positive signal this pillar has scored has arrived paired with a negative one — treat that pattern, not any single day's headline, as the base rate.
- **The new Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan defense pact could itself be read as escalatory, not stabilizing.** A mutual-defense treaty involving a nuclear power (Pakistan) raises the theoretical ceiling on how bad this could get if any signatory is drawn into direct conflict — this report treats it as net-neutral/deterrence, but a bear case would weight the tail risk higher.
- **Iran's state media announcement is not a negotiated agreement.** A one-sided IRNA statement describing terms the other party rejects is not the same as a ratified, bilateral, government-binding agreement — prior cycles in this war have seen official statements walked back or superseded within days.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a route map with an unresolved fee dispute and a widening conflict is not obviously more durable than any of the prior lulls that broke within days.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026; re-verified again same day by the full weekly refresh (draft2), no changes to levels.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed	NOT the campaign's first fatality as this draft originally claimed. Draft2 (same-day full weekly refresh, second adversarial pass) re-checked the toll directly: Wikipedia shows 18, gCaptain "at least 15," IMO's own tracker 19 (broader Middle East scope) — honest range 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not a clean "18th." Still the reason this cycle is left as a draft, alongside the full-weekly-refresh exclusion
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime	Shift from harassment/attacks to active enforcement and detention — contributed to the Aug 22 re-rate
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"	CORRECTED Aug 22 draft: NOT the first direct attack on the UAE (April, May incidents predate it). RECONCILED by draft2: separate Aug 19-dated reporting (WaPo, NBC, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) initially flagged as a possible second incident is the same episode, not new
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran	Dated, corroborated response independent of the missile-attribution dispute — contributed to the Aug 20 re-rate; re-confirmed as the same event by draft2's reconciliation
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed	Held against the "very close" framing — no re-rate up until actually signed and durable; no new signature reported through Aug 22
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22	None found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline — evidence of a continuing pattern, not a fresh shock, this cycle
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)	Drove part of the Aug 20 re-rate; independently re-verified this cycle
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait	New third-party threat — contributed to the re-rate; independently re-verified this cycle

Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)	Sharpest shipping deterioration logged yet — contributed to the re-rate; independently re-verified this cycle
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury	First reported crew injury from a Strait incident in several cycles — folded into the Aug 20 picture
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim	Comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern on its own — now folded into the broader Aug 18-20 picture
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases to ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low	Hardening of an existing dispute, not new — held flat, no P move
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed	Comparable to the Aug 8-9 incidents — held flat, no P move
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day	Comparable to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit — held flat, no P move
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"	Consistent with the Aug 8 baseline — held flat, no P move
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo cut — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state	Contributed to the Aug 8 cut — already IN the committed baseline
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new tanker attack	Resolved, signed, and durable = re-rate up meaningfully; talks stall, Iran's demands keep growing, or attacks continue = re-rate down further
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact	A genuine de-escalation-adjacent structural development, but the pact also raises tail risk given Pakistan's nuclear status

By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows
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The flip line, re-leveled: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, the conflict widening to a further new state with *confirmed* (not disputed) attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. As of Aug 22 (re-checked again same day by the full weekly refresh) we remain short of that line — no new US casualty, no new US strikes since Aug 1, Brent ~\$93-95 (a second straight weekly gain) is elevated but well under \$100, and the UAE missile claim remains single-source and disputed (and, per draft2's reconciliation, is one episode, not two). The tanker campaign's latest death and the Amara seizure are real but don't independently clear the flip line as written (a foreign, not US, death in an already-deadly campaign; a boarding, not a US casualty or strike) — the campaign's cumulative death toll, re-verified this cycle at 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers) rather than a flat "18th," remains a separate, open question about whether this pillar's baseline has been too generous, not a flip-line question. If the UAE attribution firms up, if Bessent's promised sanctions package actually lands and Iran retaliates militarily, or if the campaign's casualty count is pinned down to a single trusted tracker on further review, that would move closer to the line — worth Alex's attention next cycle. The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement **the US actually accepts** that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure. Nothing so far has cleared that bar.

My Decision

🕒 **DRAFT2 — AUGUST 22, 2026 · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P (2026-08-22_draft2): 14 / 22 / 38 / 54 / 76 (HELD FLAT vs. draft) · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

This is a separate, same-day FULL WEEKLY refresh — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — on top of this morning's Aug 22 draft (which had provisionally re-rated down at the front end versus the Aug 16 committed baseline, 20/28/41/56/77 → 14/22/38/54/76, after four parallel primary-source research passes and a dedicated adversarial fact-check that caught a real error: this report's original claim that the Minoan Dignity strike, Aug 17-18, was "the first confirmed fatality" in the tanker campaign was FALSE). This cycle independently re-researched the pillar and ran a *second*, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether that casualty-toll claim holds up, and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. **It holds up, softened:** cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest toll at a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing now runs throughout this report. **No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. A UAE missile-attack claim initially re-flagged as a possible miss (Aug 19 reporting: Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) reconciles to the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline** — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event, not two. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" — genuinely disputed, both sides single-source. Iran's first vessel seizure since June 22 (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island) remains confirmed. The UAE-attack-history correction (not the first direct hit — April, May incidents predate it) remains confirmed.

P HELD FLAT across all five windows. The evidence since Aug 20 doesn't clear the sufficiency bar for another move in either direction — it's a mix of (a) confirmation of the already-priced-in casualty finding, now with a softened, ranged framing instead of a point figure, (b) reconciliation of an initially-flagged "miss" into the same already-known event, and (c) a continuing-deadlock diplomatic picture (Iran-Oman still unsigned, CENTCOM's tally climbing incrementally, Brent ~\$93-95 on a second straight weekly gain but still under \$100) consistent with, not worse than, the existing baseline.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one**. The real test is still ahead: whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds. The real risk paths — a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, confirmed widening to a further new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 — remain unfired.

Why this is left as a draft, not auto-stamped: this time it's simple — this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, and full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how clean the findings are. By the numbers alone it would also qualify for a hold-as-draft treatment even under daily rules (no window moved at all this cycle, no master call band flipped), but the categorical exclusion is the operative reason here, not an unresolved flag. The open question carried from this morning — whether this pillar has under-scored the tanker campaign's real severity for weeks, now that its actual toll is pinned down to a 15-19 range rather than unknown — remains Alex's to weigh; this cycle's job was to make sure that range is as accurate as I can make it before he does.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

August 22, 2026 — this section covers the same-day FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) run on top of the morning's catch-up cycle. Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered (no render/archive/commit), and an Aug 21 session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers (2 of 6 reports touched) before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes, cutting P to 14/22/38/54/76 and delivering it as a draft. This afternoon's full weekly refresh independently re-researched the pillar again and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel escalation vector"). None were rendered, verified, or archived.
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treated as not-delivered per house discipline, not trusted at face value.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) described it as "the first confirmed fatality," then corrected to "roughly the 18th such death" — a toll this report had never surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check; re-confirmed again this cycle.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel escalation vector" framing driving the Aug 20 manual-review hold was retired; re-confirmed again this cycle.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18), gCaptain (mid-July, "at least 15"), and IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (19, but broader-Middle-East scoped, not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing a UAE missile attack and trade-embargo response was initially flagged by this cycle's adversarial pass as a possible miss; confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. ~67 shortly before); the Iran-Oman corridor deal remains unsigned as of Aug 22; Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a scoring input.
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; **HELD FLAT this cycle. LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED** — this time because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority, not because of an unresolved flag. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 22, 2026 (earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below):** Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative toll 18 (17 seafarers + 1 port worker) · gCaptain (mid-July snapshot) — "at least 15" · IMO's "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (imo.org, fetched directly) — 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include

- the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike, 6 killed per Al Jazeera) — NET FINDING: honest range 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not a flat "18th death"; this softens the morning draft's framing throughout this report · Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday (all Aug 19) — UAE missile-attack and trade-embargo reporting, initially flagged as a possible second incident, reconciled on cross-reference to the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera) · independent re-check for Aug 19-22 vessel strikes/seizures/incidents — none found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline · TradingEconomics, Bloomberg (Aug 20-21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl, second straight weekly gain (~6%), highest since late July.
- **August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below):** Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own initial "first confirmed fatality" framing of the Minoan Dignity strike; Riviera's own coverage frames the death as roughly the 18th seafarer death since the campaign began late Feb 2026, UN News separately reports three seafarers killed in a June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets (see draft2 entry above for this cycle's further re-verification, which settles on a 15-19 range) · Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, Gulf News, The National, and UAE's own mofa.gov.ae — CONFIRMS the UAE-attack-history correction: a large Iran-attributed missile/drone barrage hit UAE Apr 1-8 (ceasefire Apr 8) and again at Fujairah Petroleum Industries Zone May 4 (3 wounded, oil-loading disrupted), both predating and contradicting the "novel escalation vector" framing carried since Aug 20.
 - **August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes):** UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed (see adversarial fact-check above for the corrected "not the first fatality" framing) · Fars News, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News (Aug 17-19) — tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's toll regime, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down · home.treasury.gov / Bessent public statements (Aug 20-22) — sanctions package promised, pushed to "early next week"; narrower Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah-network designation confirmed as the only concrete action found · TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune (Aug 21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl · Iranian state media (Aug 22) — Iran will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
 - **August 18-20 verification:** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag" · CNN, Washington Post, and Fortune (Aug 19) — UAE suspends all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran · UK Maritime Trade Operations (Aug 18) — commercial vessel struck by unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new sanctions rhetoric); same-day, Trump softens "no time schedule" framing, says US "might return to negotiations at some point... situation is so good" · TradingEconomics / Bloomberg (Aug 19) — Brent ~\$92/bbl · *Financial Times*, citing unnamed Iranian officials — *claim that Iran assessed potential strikes on US assets in Europe (Bulgaria airbase, Cyprus, fiber cables). Single-source, uncorroborated by any second outlet this cycle; logged as a watch item, explicitly NOT used to move any P.* · Bitstamp — BTC \$71,882.92 (Aug 20 close) vs. \$64,285.10 (Aug 18 close).
 - **August 17-18 draft sources (never delivered as a report; independently re-verified this cycle against the above and found accurate):** CBS News — live desk, "Trump threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in stalemate as 60-day negotiation period ends" (Aug 17-18; MoU lapse, Iran's "US began violating" claim, Oman threat, Strait traffic 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 prior weekend; pre-war baseline re-checked this cycle to ~110/day, not the ~130/day originally carried; Brent \$90.87) · CNN — "Deadline to reach US-Iran deal expires, Trump threatens Oman" (Aug 17) · Al Jazeera — live blog, MoU expiry coverage (Aug 17) · TradingEconomics — Brent \$90.97 (Aug 18).
 - **August 16 light daily check:** Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO), Vance remarks on energy-price priority, WTI ~\$81 · Bloomberg — "Iran, Oman Home In on Hormuz Strait Deal as Ship Attacks Mount" (Aug 15) — confirms the interim arrangement is still advancing, not collapsed, despite continued shipping attacks.
 - **August 14 light daily check:** US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman deal could break impasse" · Washington Post — "Iran says deal with Oman is close — but its demands leave Hormuz opening uncertain" · The Hill — "Iran's steep demands for US over Strait of Hormuz threaten to derail reopening" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — all confirm the same stalled-on-compensation dispute, hardened not resolved; a live tracker (straits.live) shows day 166 of Strait closure.
 - **August 13 light daily check:** CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US" (Araghchi conditions reopening on US "making amends" over the June MoU) · Bloomberg, Fortune — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no signing found as of Aug 13.
 - **August 11 light daily check:** NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement of no injuries · Wikipedia "2026

Strait of Hormuz crisis" and Bloomberg/Marine Log Aug 5 route-agreement coverage re-checked — no signing found as of Aug 11.

- **August 10 light daily check:** GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia — "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" live tracker, re-checked, last update Aug 8 · no new dated catalyst found beyond these.
- **August 9 light daily check:** Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rappler (Aug 8-9) — Araqchi's "very close"/US-compensation comment, the UAE's new ship-hit report, and Oman's condemnation of "repeated attacks" all trace to this single Reuters wire story.
- **August 8 full-weekly additions:** Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera, Japan Times — Najran strike, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) · wire coverage of the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact (Aug 7) · Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6) · NPR — "Iran says agreement with Oman for Strait of Hormuz prohibits U.S. and Israeli vessels" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: What do they all want?" (Aug 5) · Bloomberg — "Iran-Oman Deal Proposes Ban on US, Israeli Ships in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 6) · CNBC — US official rejects one-sided fee/ban terms (Aug 6).
- **August 7 additions:** Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Shipping in the Strait of Hormuz will not be subject to fees until a final agreement is reached with Iran," citing US officials (Aug 7) · CNN live updates — continuing Iran/Oman/US Hormuz coverage, Iran's IRGC commander reiterates nuclear-development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile.
- **August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 6) and "Iran, Oman Reach Agreement on Proposed Strait of Hormuz Shipping Route" (Aug 5) · CBS News — live updates, Iran/Oman deal getting close · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran and Oman agree route for ships" (Aug 5) · Fortune — "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6), fee figures (5-7% Iran, ~3% Oman, 0% US) · Jerusalem Post — "Proposed Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" · Forbes — "Hormuz Is Becoming A Fee-And-Permission Regime" (background, Jul 28) · Fast Company / DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior revised to 198K (Aug 6).
- **August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** globalsecurity.org — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO-sourced reporting via globalsecurity.org — second disabled tanker off Musandam · Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, Tribune — Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels planned joint US-Israeli strike, "perimeters of a deal" (Aug 4) · iransitrep.com — bulkier struck and blacked out in the Strait (Aug 4) · Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, Al-Quds — first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal (Aug 5) · CNN — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday (Aug 5).
- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan (Jul 28-29), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed, corroborated by CBS News and Foreign Policy · Al Jazeera — drone strike on Egypt's Damietta port, corroborated by CNBC and Times of Israel · CNN — "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries" (Jul 30) · Fortune — Brent ~\$92-93 (Jul 30) · CNN — Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks (Jul 27).
- **July 11-13 additions (prior full refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack drones, Jul 12) · Al Jazeera (multiple, Jul 12-13) — Hormuz-closed declaration, shipping-intelligence data via Windward, Oman strike coverage · Bloomberg (Jul 12) · NPR (Jul 11) · Washington Times (Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador summoned · Naharnet and Iran International — Iran/Oman/Qatar median-lane two-route corridor proposal · Business Recorder and RTÉ (Jul 13) — Iran FM spokesman Esmail Baqaei on continuing mediator talks · Middle East Eye and TASS — GFS Galaxy attack and rescue (Jul 11) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · Kaieteur News — Iranian Health Ministry casualty figures (17 killed / 115 wounded, unverified government claim) · CryptoTimes, CoinDesk, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinga (Jul 13) — BTC weekend pullback to news-reported ~\$62,000–63,000 intraday range, mixed FOMC/CPI-vs-Iran attribution, first weekly BTC ETF inflow in nine weeks.
- **July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — Araqchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (referenced Jul 11).

- **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Al Jazeera — second-night strikes & the peace process (July 9) · Gulf News — Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10; 451 at retrieval, cited via search) · Times of Israel — July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya (single-source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 8) · Insurance Journal — traffic near halt, war-risk 2–6% of hull value (July 9) · The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · *(Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source)* · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · *Direct Polymarket fetch failed twice this week (July 13); "US invades Iran before 2027" relayed via secondary aggregators only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.*